

Toddler Picky Eating Power Struggle — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

ASSESS YOUR SITUATION

- ☐ **Assess Your Situation, Identify the signs of significant food selectivity by checking whether your child eats fewer than 15 foods reliably across multiple days and has dropped foods recently without adding new ones to their diet.:** Assess Your Situation, Identify the signs of significant food selectivity by checking whether your child eats fewer than 15 foods reliably across multiple days and has dropped foods recently without adding new ones to their diet.
- ☐ **Assess Your Situation, Consult your pediatrician about a feeding evaluation if your child gags on textures, has lost weight, or accepts fewer than 10 foods — this guide complements but does not replace professional support.:** Assess Your Situation, Consult your pediatrician about a feeding evaluation if your child gags on textures, has lost weight, or accepts fewer than 10 foods — this guide complements but does not replace professional support.
- ☐ **Assess Your Situation, Recognize that pressuring your child to eat actually worsens food avoidance by teaching their brain that new foods are associated with negative emotions and conflict at the table.:** Assess Your Situation, Recognize that pressuring your child to eat actually worsens food avoidance by teaching their brain that new foods are associated with negative emotions and conflict at the table.
- ☐ **Assess Your Situation, Accept that the Division of Responsibility means letting go of the need to get your child to eat — your job is the what, when, and where, not the whether and how much.:** Assess Your Situation, Accept that the Division of Responsibility means letting go of the need to get your child to eat — your job is the what, when, and where, not the whether and how much.

RESTRUCTURE MEALTIMES

- ☐ **Restructure Mealtimes, Create a structured meal schedule with breakfast, lunch, and dinner at consistent times and eliminate all snacking between meals so your child arrives at the table genuinely hungry.:** Restructure Mealtimes, Create a structured meal schedule with breakfast, lunch, and dinner at consistent times and eliminate all snacking between meals so your child arrives at the table genuinely hungry.
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- **Restructure Mealtimes, Serve the same meal to everyone at the table without making separate foods or accommodations for your child — this removes special treatment and normalizes all foods.:** Restructure Mealtimes, Serve the same meal to everyone at the table without making separate foods or accommodations for your child — this removes special treatment and normalizes all foods.
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- **Restructure Mealtimes, Present the meal without pressure by saying "This is what's for dinner. You don't have to eat it" and then say nothing else about what your child chooses to eat or not eat.:** Restructure Mealtimes, Present the meal without pressure by saying "This is what's for dinner. You don't have to eat it" and then say nothing else about what your child chooses to eat or not eat.
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- **Restructure Mealtimes, Clear the plates at the end of each meal without any commentary about what was eaten, how much was consumed, or any expressions of disappointment or relief.:** Restructure Mealtimes, Clear the plates at the end of each meal without any commentary about what was eaten, how much was consumed, or any expressions of disappointment or relief.
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SHIFT YOUR RESPONSE

- **Shift Your Response, Understand that your child's food refusal is a genuine threat-detection response in their brain, not stubbornness or manipulation — they are trying to protect themselves from danger.:** Shift Your Response, Understand that your child's food refusal is a genuine threat-detection response in their brain, not stubbornness or manipulation — they are trying to protect themselves from danger.
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- **Shift Your Response, Use repeated, low-pressure exposure to new foods over time instead of pressure or demands, which allows the threat response in your child's brain to gradually decrease and the food to become acceptable.:** Shift Your Response, Use repeated, low-pressure exposure to new foods over time instead of pressure or demands, which allows the threat response in your child's brain to gradually decrease and the food to become acceptable.
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- **Shift Your Response, Remove all pressure from mealtimes by eliminating pleading, bargaining, commenting on amounts, or expressing frustration when your child refuses to eat.:** Shift Your Response, Remove all pressure from mealtimes by eliminating pleading, bargaining, commenting on amounts, or expressing frustration when your child refuses to eat.
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- ☐ **Shift Your Response, Trust the Division of Responsibility framework completely by controlling only the food, timing, and location of meals while allowing your child to control whether and how much they eat.:** Shift Your Response, Trust the Division of Responsibility framework completely by controlling only the food, timing, and location of meals while allowing your child to control whether and how much they eat.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.